

*Illustration by* TANMOY CHAKRABORTY

## THE CHANGE-MAKERS

### RELIANCE LIFE SCIENCES

↘ Globally, it sells the largest number of biosimilar products. Currently, it markets 21 biosimilars in India and abroad and will soon be launching two more

↘ It's also developing 15 more biosimilars for oncology, immunology, cardiology, pulmonology, haematology, neurology and orthopaedics

### BIOCON

↘ It has eight products in the market and its insulin product Semglee was the first interchangeable biosimilar to obtain FDA approval in the US

↘ It also has a future pipeline of 20 biosimilar molecules, targeting an over $70 billion (Rs 5.8 lakh crore) addressable global market through it by FY27

### DR REDDY'S

↘ A relatively new entrant in the biosimilars market, Dr Reddy's this year completed clinical studies for its rituximab biosimilar candidate, which can be used to treat blood cancer and some autoimmune disorders. The product has already been approved in India and over 25 emerging markets

**1,128**

**BIOTECH STARTUPS**

New registrations in 2021, the highest in a single year since 2015. As of 2021, biotech startups numbered a significant 5,365 in India

**$10-20**

**MILLION**

(or Rs 83 crore-Rs 166 crore) The cost of developing a biosimilar in India per the Generics and Biosimilars Initiative, as compared to $100-$200 million in the US or EU

## ↘ WHAT INDIA NEEDS TO MASTER

According to market research firm Insights10, India's biosimilars market size was valued at $349 million (Rs 2,906 crore) in 2022 and is estimated to expand at a CAGR of 25.2 per cent till 2030, by which time it will be worth $2.1 billion (Rs 17,480 crore). In the coming years, around 10 biologics will be free of patents—a huge opportunity for Indian firms to increase their global market share. But challenges remain, especially in terms of designing a credible regulatory framework. In 2009, the World Health Organization (WHO) had issued guidelines for the regulatory evaluation of biosimilars. A 2019-20 survey by it revealed four significant difficulties that 20 countries, including India, continued to face: unavailable/insufficient reference products, lack of resources, problems with the quality of some biosimilars and difficulties with the practice of interchangeability and naming of biosimilars. While India has approved more than 60 biosimilars in the recent past, experts say approvals must be tightened and given only on the basis of large-scale clinical data. India's biggest priority in the biosimilars race is aligning swift innovation with credibility. ■